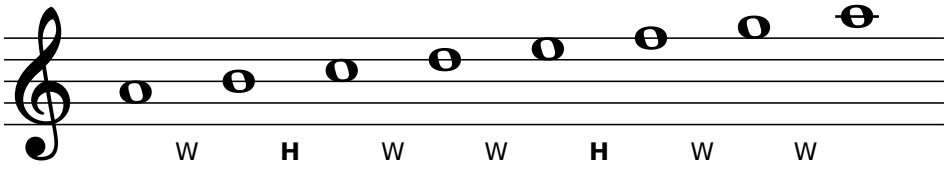
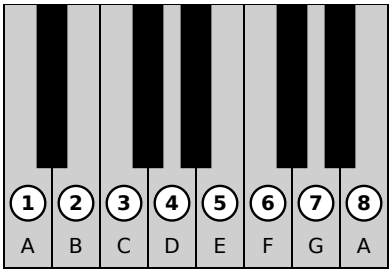
The Natural Minor Scale

The **natural minor scale** follows this pattern of whole steps (W) and half steps (H): **W H W W H W W**. The half steps fall between degrees 2 and 3 and between degrees 5 and 6. A natural minor uses only white keys, from A to A.

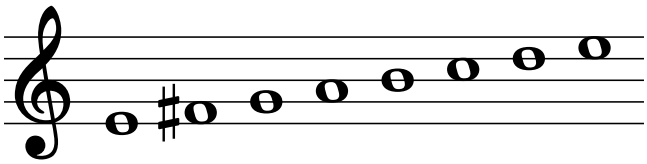


A natural minor: A B C D E F G A

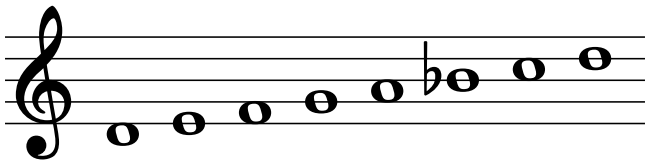


A natural minor on the keyboard, with degree numbers.

A natural minor scale uses the same notes as its relative major, starting on degree 6 of the major scale. A minor uses the notes of C major; E minor uses the notes of G major, with F♯; D minor uses the notes of F major, with B♭.



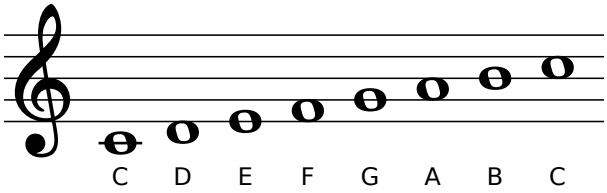
E natural minor: one sharp, F♯



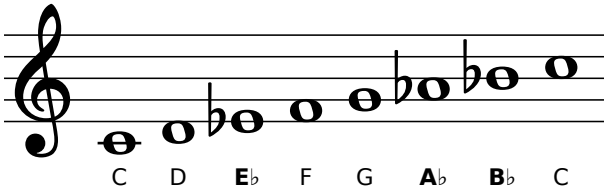
D natural minor: one flat, B♭

Parallel keys

Keys with the same tonic but different modes, such as C major and C minor, are **parallel keys**. Compared with the major scale on the same tonic, the natural minor scale lowers degrees 3, 6, and 7 by a half step. In natural minor, degree 7 lies a whole step below the tonic and is called the **subtonic** rather than the leading tone.



C major



C natural minor: degrees 3, 6, and 7 lowered

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Name _____ Date _____

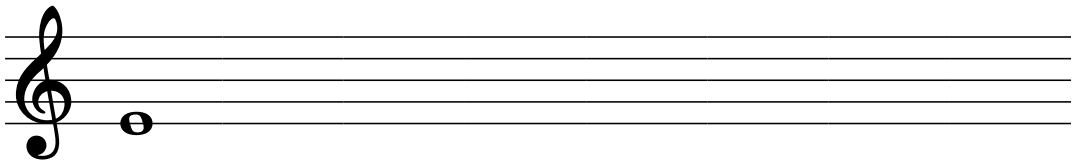
Natural Minor Scales

A. The natural minor pattern Fill in the pattern of whole steps (W) and half steps (H). The first step is given.

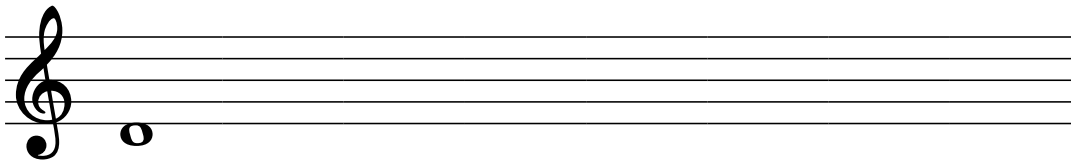
Natural minor:	W						

B. Write natural minor scales Write each scale as whole notes, ascending, with the sharps or flats it needs. Mark each half step with a bracket.

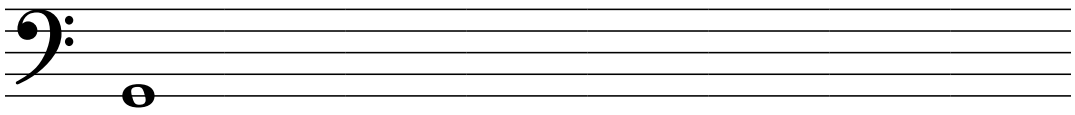
E natural minor



D natural minor

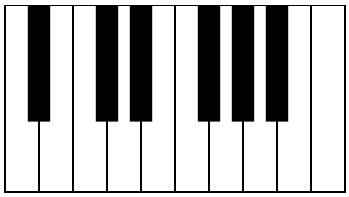


G natural minor

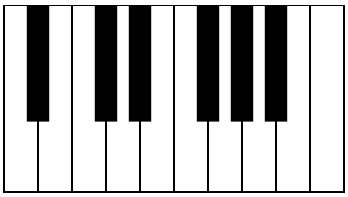


C. Natural minor on the keyboard Shade the keys of each scale, starting on the lowest key named.

1. B natural minor, starting on B3



2. C natural minor, starting on C4



D. Relative or parallel? Write relative or parallel for each pair of keys.

EXAMPLE C major, A minor: relative

1. C major, C minor: _____
2. G major, E minor: _____
3. D major, D minor: _____
4. F major, D minor: _____
5. A major, A minor: _____
6. D major, B minor: _____
7. G major, G minor: _____
8. E♭ major, C minor: _____
9. F major, F minor: _____

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